

2d. Content of Investigative geography (H481/04, 05)

Investigative geography (04/05) gives learners the opportunity to undertake an independent investigation which is of particular interest to them, which can be related to any area of the specification.

An independent investigation in A Level Geography provides learners with the opportunity to develop a wide range of skills and abilities which are applicable not only to study in Higher Education but also within the world of work and life, which, amongst others, include:

- the structure and enquiry process
- extended writing
- innovation in investigating and presenting data
- self-directed study
- research techniques
- making synoptic links between the real world, geographical theory, the learners own research and the specification.

The independent investigation will consist of a written report which will assess the process of enquiry and investigation. The report must be an independent investigation but data collection can be conducted within a group.

The independent investigation must:

- be based on a question or issue defined and developed by the learner individually to address aims, questions and/or hypotheses relating to any part of the specification
- incorporate data and/or evidence from field investigations collected individually or in groups

- draw on learner's own field data and, if relevant, secondary data sourced by the learner
- require the learner independently to contextualise, analyse and summarise findings and data
- involve the individual drawing of conclusions and their communication by means of extended writing and the presentation of relevant data.

The report must contain a clear structure and continuous prose, and if the report includes digital material then this must be referenced to or evidenced through weblinks and/or screenshots. The report must include the collection of primary and secondary data. Primary data is defined here as unmanipulated data, either collected in the field or a raw dataset.

Learning hours are not specified because the process of writing the report is an iterative and independent process, however a length of between 3000 and 4000 words is recommended. Each learner will work at their own pace and time should be made available to explain to learners what is required before they undertake the initial stages of research.

Investigative geography (04/05) is internally assessed and externally moderated. The independent investigation will be marked by the centre using the marking criteria grid provided by OCR in Section 3f Non-exam Assessment – Investigative geography (04/05).